

SilverTech Directory — Tour Guide

20 Questions to Ask on Your Memory Care Tour

Bring this guide on your visit. Memory care is one of the most specialized — and most varied — types of senior care. These questions will help you separate good from exceptional.

The Environment

1. **Is this a dedicated, locked memory care unit**, or are memory care residents mixed with the general population?
2. **How is the physical environment designed** to reduce confusion, anxiety, and wandering?
3. **Is there a secured outdoor space** residents can access freely?
4. **How is wayfinding handled** — colors, signage, visual cues — to help residents navigate?

Staffing & Training

5. **What dementia-specific training** do all staff receive, and how often is it updated?
6. **What is the staff-to-resident ratio** during the day, evening, and overnight?
7. **How long has the memory care director been in this role?**
8. **What is the staff turnover rate** in this unit specifically?

Care Approach

9. **What philosophy guides your memory care program?** (Person-centered, Teepa Snow, Montessori-based, etc.)
10. **How do you handle behavioral symptoms** like agitation, aggression, or sundowning?
11. **What happens if a resident refuses care, medications, or meals?**
12. **How are care plans personalized** for different stages of dementia?

Safety

13. **What is your elopement prevention protocol?** What happens if a resident exits the unit?
14. **What is your policy on physical restraints** and antipsychotic medications?
15. **How are medications reviewed?** Is there a consulting pharmacist or geriatrician?

Family & Communication

16. **Can family members visit at any time**, including evenings and weekends?
17. **How do you communicate changes in a resident's condition** to family?
18. **How do you support family members** who are grieving the changes in their loved one?

Transition & End of Life

19. **What happens when a resident progresses to a stage requiring higher medical care?** Is hospice provided on-site?
20. **Have there been any state citations or violations** in this unit in the past two years?

Trust your instincts. Watch how staff interact with residents who are having a difficult moment — that tells you more than any answer.

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